1. He/she appoints the Prime Minister and accepts his/her resignation.
2. He/she appoints and dismisses the other members of the government (Council of Ministers) on the advice of the Prime Minister.
3. He/she presides over the meetings of Council of Ministers. This provides him/her a direct opportunity to influence, guide, direct and control the policies of the government.
4. He/she makes appointments to civil and military posts of the state.
5. He/she is the commander-in-chief of the armed forces of the country.
6. He/she negotiates and ratifies treaties and sends and receives diplomats.
7. He/she is kept informed of all the negotiations leading to the conclusion of an international agreement not subject to ratification.
8. He/she presides over the higher councils and committees of national defence.
9. He/she presides over and represents the French community.
10. He/she appoints the President and three members of the Constitutional Council.
11. He/she promulgates the laws within fifteen days following their final adoption by the Parliament and transmission to the government. However, before the end of this period, he/she can ask the Parliament to reconsider a law. This reconsideration cannot be refused by the Parliament.
12. He/she can send messages to the Parliament and summon its special sessions.
13. He/she can submit to a referendum any government bill on the proposal of the government during the parliamentary sessions or on the joint proposal of the two Houses of the Parliament. If the bill is approved in the referendum, the President should promulgate it within fifteen days.
14. He/she signs the ordinances and decrees that have been considered by the Council of Ministers.
15. He/she has the right to pardon.
16. He/she presides over the Higher Council of the judiciary. He/she also appoints nine members to it.
17. He/she is the protector of the independence of the judicial authority.
18. He/she is vested with special powers to deal with emergencies. During this period, he/she can take the required measures after consulting the Prime Minister, the Presidents of the two Assemblies (Houses) of the Parliament and the Constitutional Council.
19. He/she can dissolve the National Assembly, after consulting the Prime Minister and the Presidents of the two Assemblies (Houses of the Parliament). The Constitution, however, imposes two limitations: (i) He/she cannot dissolve the National Assembly more than once in twelve months and (ii) the National Assembly cannot be dissolved during an emergency. Notably, the President is not required to follow the advice of the prime minister and the Presidents of the two Assemblies. Further, the President can refuse dissolution when asked by the prime minister.